



A: Uday was absolutely right. Just look at the money flowing into mutual funds through SIPs (systematic investment plans) every month... these are stunning numbers... ₹21,000 crore... ₹23,000 crore... ₹24,000 crore—those are of course gross numbers. There are break-offs as well at a very high rate. But still, a lot of money is flowing into that. The Indian consumer is financially savvier than the American or UK consumer.

Q: Why is that so?

A: It's the mindset. The average American consumer or the average UK consumer is not that financially savvy. For Indians, it's in our blood, it's in our DNA. **We are taught very early how impor-**

“We want to be the go-to financial services organisation for aspirational Indians, fuelling their aspirations, partnering them, [and] giving them the courage to go ahead with their aspirations”

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tant money is and how you should be savvy about money. That's just the way we have all been brought up... And you can get away with a lot of other stuff in the UK or the US, which you would never be able to get away with in India. The Indian consumer would hold you to that. The Indian consumer is saying, 'Look, I want a better return on my money. And mutual funds in the stock market are giving me that.'

Having said that, deposits are usually a function of economic activity. And as long as there are heightened levels of economic activity, deposit levels continue... even in a market like the US, where 61% of the people would have some kind of mutual fund compared to 6% here. If you take say checking accounts, which is what we call current accounts, as a percentage of GDP it has continued to be high. There will be a quarter when there will be some tightness, there will be some quarters when there will be less tightness, but generally speaking, deposits grow in line with GDP. That I think will continue.